

BUSINESS COMMUNICATION

UNIT 1 — ESSENTIAL ENGLISH GRAMMAR

BCA • SEMESTER 1 • EXAM-READY STUDENT NOTES

12 TENSES • RULES • EXAMPLES • EXAM QUESTIONS • MCQs • PRACTICE

HOW TO USE THESE NOTES

Read the chapter explanation first. At the **END of every chapter**, revise the yellow **EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE** box. The dark MCQ and question sections are designed for quick revision.

CHAPTER 1 — TENSES

A **tense** shows the time of an action or state. English commonly uses present, past and future time with simple, continuous, perfect and perfect continuous aspects.

12-TENSE REVISION MAP

PRESENT	PAST	FUTURE
Simple Present	Simple Past	Simple Future
Present Continuous	Past Continuous	Future Continuous
Present Perfect	Past Perfect	Future Perfect
Present Perfect Continuous	Past Perfect Continuous	Future Perfect Continuous

1. SIMPLE PRESENT

Explanation: habits, routines, repeated actions, facts and general truths

Formula: Subject + V1 (s/es with he, she, it)

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
She studies every day.	She does not study every day.
QUESTION	WH QUESTION
Does she study every day?	When does she study?

Important words: every day, usually, often, always, sometimes, never

Common mistake: With he/she/it add s/es. After do/does use V1.

Student shortcut: Routine/general fact → SIMPLE PRESENT.

Practice: She ____ every day. (study)

Answer: She studies every day.

■ EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE

2 MARK QUESTION: Define SIMPLE PRESENT and write its formula.

5 MARK QUESTION: Explain SIMPLE PRESENT with structure and suitable positive, negative and interrogative examples.

VERY IMPORTANT: Learn the formula, signal words and one example by heart.

2. PRESENT CONTINUOUS

Explanation: an action happening now or a temporary situation

Formula: Subject + am/is/are + V-ing

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
She is studying now.	She is not studying now.
QUESTION	WH QUESTION
Is she studying now?	What is she studying?

Important words: now, at the moment, currently, today

Common mistake: Do not normally use stative verbs such as know or believe in continuous form.

Student shortcut: Action in progress now → PRESENT CONTINUOUS.

Practice: I ___ an email now. (write)

Answer: I am writing an email now.

■ EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE

2 MARK QUESTION: Define PRESENT CONTINUOUS and write its formula.

5 MARK QUESTION: Explain PRESENT CONTINUOUS with structure and suitable positive, negative and interrogative examples.

VERY IMPORTANT: Learn the formula, signal words and one example by heart.

3. PRESENT PERFECT

Explanation: a completed action connected with the present, experience, or unspecified past time

Formula: Subject + has/have + V3

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
She has finished her assignment.	She has not finished it.
QUESTION	WH QUESTION
Has she finished it?	What have you completed?

Important words: already, just, yet, ever, never, recently, so far

Common mistake: Do not normally combine it with a finished past time such as yesterday.

Student shortcut: Past action + present connection → PRESENT PERFECT.

Practice: He ____ his work. (finish)

Answer: He has finished his work.

■ EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE

2 MARK QUESTION: Define PRESENT PERFECT and write its formula.

5 MARK QUESTION: Explain PRESENT PERFECT with structure and suitable positive, negative and interrogative examples.

VERY IMPORTANT: Learn the formula, signal words and one example by heart.

4. PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS

Explanation: an activity that started in the past and continues now, with focus on duration

Formula: Subject + has/have been + V-ing

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
She has been studying for two hours.	She has not been studying for two hours.
QUESTION	WH QUESTION
Has she been studying for two hours?	How long have you been studying?

Important words: since, for, all day, lately

Common mistake: Since = starting point; for = duration.

Student shortcut: Activity + duration up to now → PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS.

Practice: I ___ since 7 a.m. (study)

Answer: I have been studying since 7 a.m.

■ EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE

2 MARK QUESTION: Define PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS and write its formula.

5 MARK QUESTION: Explain PRESENT PERFECT CONTINUOUS with structure and suitable positive, negative and interrogative examples.

VERY IMPORTANT: Learn the formula, signal words and one example by heart.

5. SIMPLE PAST

Explanation: completed actions at a definite time in the past

Formula: Subject + V2

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
She visited Delhi yesterday.	She did not visit Delhi.
QUESTION	WH QUESTION
Did she visit Delhi?	Where did she go?

Important words: yesterday, last week, ago, in 2024

Common mistake: After did/did not use V1: Did he go, not Did he went.

Student shortcut: Finished past action → SIMPLE PAST.

Practice: We ___ a movie yesterday. (watch)

Answer: We watched a movie yesterday.

■ EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE

2 MARK QUESTION: Define SIMPLE PAST and write its formula.

5 MARK QUESTION: Explain SIMPLE PAST with structure and suitable positive, negative and interrogative examples.

VERY IMPORTANT: Learn the formula, signal words and one example by heart.

6. PAST CONTINUOUS

Explanation: an action in progress at a particular past time, often interrupted by another action

Formula: Subject + was/were + V-ing

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
I was reading at 8 p.m.	I was not reading at 8 p.m.
QUESTION	WH QUESTION
Were you reading at 8 p.m.?	What were you doing?

Important words: while, when, at that time

Common mistake: Was = I/he/she/it; were = you/we/they.

Student shortcut: Past action in progress → PAST CONTINUOUS.

Practice: She ____ when I called. (sleep)

Answer: She was sleeping when I called.

■ EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE

2 MARK QUESTION: Define PAST CONTINUOUS and write its formula.

5 MARK QUESTION: Explain PAST CONTINUOUS with structure and suitable positive, negative and interrogative examples.

VERY IMPORTANT: Learn the formula, signal words and one example by heart.

7. PAST PERFECT

Explanation: one past action that happened before another past action

Formula: Subject + had + V3

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
She had left before I arrived.	She had not left before I arrived.
QUESTION	WH QUESTION
Had she left before you arrived?	Why had she left?

Important words: before, after, already, by the time

Common mistake: Earlier action uses had + V3; later action normally uses simple past.

Student shortcut: Earlier past → PAST PERFECT.

Practice: The train ____ before we reached. (leave)

Answer: The train had left before we reached.

■ EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE

2 MARK QUESTION: Define PAST PERFECT and write its formula.

5 MARK QUESTION: Explain PAST PERFECT with structure and suitable positive, negative and interrogative examples.

VERY IMPORTANT: Learn the formula, signal words and one example by heart.

8. PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS

Explanation: duration of an activity before another past point

Formula: Subject + had been + V-ing

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
She had been studying for two hours before dinner.	She had not been studying for two hours.
QUESTION	WH QUESTION
Had she been studying for two hours?	How long had she been studying?

Important words: for, since, before

Common mistake: Use it when activity and duration before a past point are important.

Student shortcut: They ____ for an hour before the bus came. (wait)

Practice: They had been waiting for an hour before the bus came.

Answer: See the completed example above.

■ EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE

2 MARK QUESTION: Define PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS and write its formula.

5 MARK QUESTION: Explain PAST PERFECT CONTINUOUS with structure and suitable positive, negative and interrogative examples.

VERY IMPORTANT: Learn the formula, signal words and one example by heart.

9. SIMPLE FUTURE

Explanation: predictions, promises, offers, spontaneous decisions and future facts

Formula: Subject + will + V1

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
I will help you.	I will not help you.
QUESTION	WH QUESTION
Will you help me?	When will you help me?

Important words: tomorrow, next week, soon, later, probably

Common mistake: After will use V1.

Student shortcut: Prediction/promise/offer → SIMPLE FUTURE.

Practice: I ____ you tomorrow. (call)

Answer: I will call you tomorrow.

■ EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE

2 MARK QUESTION: Define SIMPLE FUTURE and write its formula.

5 MARK QUESTION: Explain SIMPLE FUTURE with structure and suitable positive, negative and interrogative examples.

VERY IMPORTANT: Learn the formula, signal words and one example by heart.

10. FUTURE CONTINUOUS

Explanation: an action that will be in progress at a particular future time

Formula: Subject + will be + V-ing

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
I will be studying at 8 p.m.	I will not be studying at 8 p.m.
QUESTION	WH QUESTION
Will you be studying at 8 p.m.?	What will you be doing?

Important words: this time tomorrow, at 8 tomorrow

Common mistake: Focus is on the action in progress.

Student shortcut: Future time + action in progress → FUTURE CONTINUOUS.

Practice: At 9 tomorrow, I ____ . (travel)

Answer: At 9 tomorrow, I will be travelling.

■ EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE

2 MARK QUESTION: Define FUTURE CONTINUOUS and write its formula.

5 MARK QUESTION: Explain FUTURE CONTINUOUS with structure and suitable positive, negative and interrogative examples.

VERY IMPORTANT: Learn the formula, signal words and one example by heart.

11. FUTURE PERFECT

Explanation: an action that will be completed before a future time/deadline

Formula: Subject + will have + V3

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
She will have completed the project by Friday.	She will not have completed it by Friday.
QUESTION	WH QUESTION
Will she have completed it by Friday?	What will you have finished?

Important words: by, by then, before

Common mistake: By + future time is a strong clue.

Student shortcut: We ____ by Monday. (finish)

Practice: We will have finished by Monday.

Answer: See the completed example above.

■ EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE

2 MARK QUESTION: Define FUTURE PERFECT and write its formula.

5 MARK QUESTION: Explain FUTURE PERFECT with structure and suitable positive, negative and interrogative examples.

VERY IMPORTANT: Learn the formula, signal words and one example by heart.

12. FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS

Explanation: duration of an activity continuing up to a future point

Formula: Subject + will have been + V-ing

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE
By June, she will have been studying here for one year.	She will not have been studying here for one year.
QUESTION	WH QUESTION
Will she have been studying here for one year?	How long will you have been studying?

Important words: for, by, by the time

Common mistake: Focus is duration up to a future reference point.

Student shortcut: By July, I ____ here for a year. (work)

Practice: By July, I will have been working here for a year.

Answer: See the completed example above.

■ EXAM MATERIAL — MUST PREPARE

2 MARK QUESTION: Define FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS and write its formula.

5 MARK QUESTION: Explain FUTURE PERFECT CONTINUOUS with structure and suitable positive, negative and interrogative examples.

VERY IMPORTANT: Learn the formula, signal words and one example by heart.

Q1. She ____ to college every day.

A) go B) goes C) going D) gone

Answer: B

Q2. They ____ playing now.

A) is B) was C) are D) has

Answer: C

Q3. He did not ____ there.

A) went B) goes C) go D) gone

Answer: C

Q4. Everyone ____ ready.

A) are B) is C) were D) be

Answer: B

Q5. I have lived here ____ 2024.

A) for B) since C) at D) by

Answer: B

Q6. I have lived here ____ two years.

A) since B) for C) at D) on

Answer: B

FINAL 1-DAY REVISION

12 tense formulas → signal words → common errors → subject-verb agreement → punctuation → MCQs
→ long questions